BONUS 01

20 READY-TO-USE VOCAL ROUTINES

Progressive twelve-minute sequences, from easy readiness to repertoire integration.



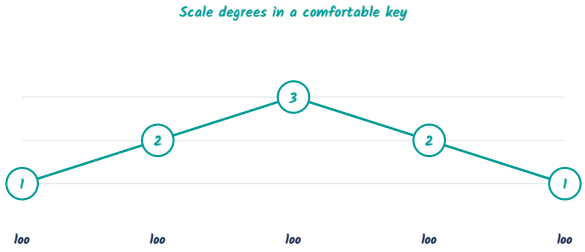
Feet supported | Use a stable chair | See the director without craning

FIND SUPPORT



ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

COORDINATE



KEEP IT EASY



Watch the preparation | Breathe without holding | "loo" on the downbeat

TRANSFER

Illustrated methods you can understand, try, and use in real music.

Use a routine with purpose

How the progression works

Routines 01-05 establish comfortable readiness, 06-10 coordinate basic skills, 11-15 combine them, and 16-20 transfer them to practical rehearsal situations. Progression means more coordination, not louder or higher singing.

Twelve minutes, with recovery

Each routine has five blocks: one minute for arrival, two for breathing and speech, three for gentle sound, three for coordination, and three for repertoire transfer. These times include modelling, listening, rest, and feedback. Do not vocalize continuously.

Before starting

Choose a comfortable starting pitch; numbered patterns are major scale degrees, not fixed notes. Allow seated participation, appropriate octave choices, a shorter pattern, speech, or listening. Stop tasks that cause pain, dizziness, or strain. Rest a hoarse or tired voice.

Check the transfer

The final block is the test: did the selected skill help the actual phrase? Keep one clear observation and choose the next routine based on the group's needs rather than completing every routine in order.



Choose a useful aim. Model the task. Notice a real result.

ROUTINE 01

Easy First Rehearsal

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

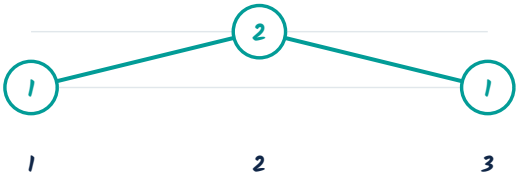
12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Build a comfortable first shared sound.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Find a supported stance and release clenched hands.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Use an ordinary breath before a quiet four-beat 'sss'; rest between turns.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Hum one note for two beats, then open to 'oo' without increasing volume.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Echo 1-2-1 on 'loo'; keep the same key until it feels easy.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Sing the first two words of today's song, then the opening phrase with the same ease.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

ROUTINE 02

Seated Readiness

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare a group that rehearses mainly seated.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Set chairs and scores so feet are supported and the director is visible.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Breathe normally, speak 'We are ready', and notice any shoulder shrug.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing two gentle 'mm-oo' sounds with a normal breathing break.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Use 3-2-1 on 'oh', pausing after every pattern.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Sing a short line from the score while looking up before its entrance.

WATCH FOR THIS

The final notes stay clear without being pushed downward.

ROUTINE 03

Quiet Morning Start

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

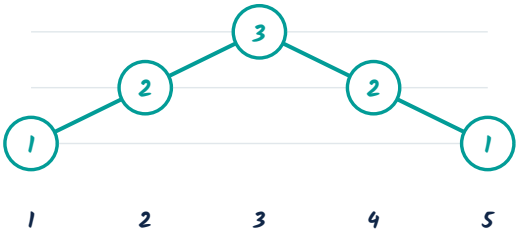
12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Begin without demanding immediate volume or range.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Check comfort and invite singers to listen if their voices feel tired.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Speak a short greeting with an easy preparatory breath.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Hum briefly on a comfortable note, rest, then repeat once on 'oo'.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Sing 1-2-3-2-1 gently, staying within a modest middle range.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Sing one phrase at a comfortable medium level; postpone high or demanding passages.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

ROUTINE 04

Clear Words Foundation

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Connect easy sound to understandable text.



ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

The mouth shape changes while pitch and volume stay reasonably steady.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Unclench the jaw and speak a short lyric conversationally.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Speak the lyric after an ordinary breath, placing a pause where its meaning allows.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing 'oo-oh-ah' on one comfortable note with a rest after each cycle.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Speak 'Bright morning, clear sky' on four beats, putting vowels on the beat.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Sing the lyric first on its vowels, then restore concise consonants.

WATCH FOR THIS

Vowel changes are audible while pitch and volume stay reasonably consistent.

ROUTINE 05

Shared Pulse Starter

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

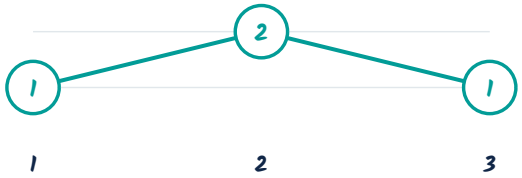
12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare coordination before adding difficult notes.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Settle the feet and establish a gentle tapping pulse.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Speak one line over four beats after a quiet preparation.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Echo 1-2-1 on 'noo', allowing four silent beats to recover.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Alternate 'ta ta ti-ti ta' and 'ta rest ta ta' without speeding up.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Speak, then sing a rhythmically simple phrase from the repertoire.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

ROUTINE 06

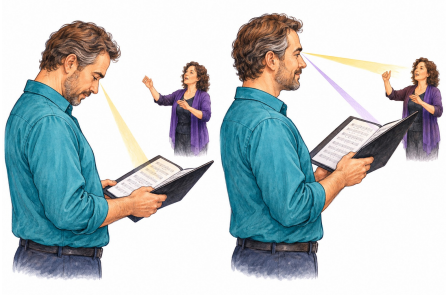
Connected Vowel Line

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

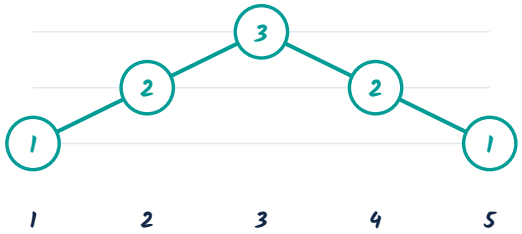
12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Keep a continuous sound through small pitch changes.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Release shoulder effort and hold the score lightly.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Speak a four-word phrase, choosing one shared breath point.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Move gently from 'mm' to 'oo' on one note.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Sing 1-2-3-2-1 on one continuous vowel, resting between repetitions.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Replace the vowel with the song's actual vowels before adding consonants.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

ROUTINE 07

Listen Then Enter

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

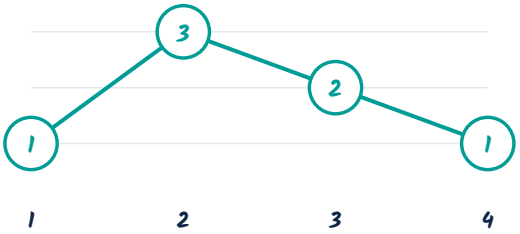
12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Improve entrances by preparing with eyes and ears.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Arrange singers so everyone has a clear view of the director.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Follow three silent preparation gestures with ordinary breaths and immediate release.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Listen to one note, hum it briefly, then hear the reference again.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Echo 1-3-2-1 only after the complete model and its response cue.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Rehearse the first entrance after a rest in today's piece.

WATCH FOR THIS

The final notes stay clear without being pushed downward.

ROUTINE 08

Descending Ease

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Keep the end of a descending line clear.



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Find a supported standing or seated position without lifting the chin.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Release an easy four-beat 'sss', followed by normal breathing.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing 3-2-1 on 'oo' with an easy ending.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

If comfortable, use 5-4-3-2-1 without pushing low notes; otherwise keep three notes.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Apply the same descending shape to one ending in the repertoire.

WATCH FOR THIS

The final notes stay clear without being pushed downward.

ROUTINE 09

Vowel Agreement

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Establish a repeatable shared vowel for one phrase.



oo — oh — ah

ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

The mouth shape changes while pitch and volume stay reasonably steady.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Speak a problematic word naturally with an easy jaw.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Read the phrase and mark an unhurried breath before it.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing 'oo-oh' on one note while keeping the pitch steady.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Compare three spoken versions of the target word and choose one appropriate to the language.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Sing the word on its melody, then place it back inside the phrase.

WATCH FOR THIS

Vowel changes are audible while pitch and volume stay reasonably consistent.

ROUTINE 10

Steady Short Phrases

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Keep the second phrase as ready as the first.



mm — oo — oh

ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

Keep one comfortable pitch and a similar volume as the vowel opens.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Release finger grip and check that the score does not hide the cue.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Speak two short lines with a clear recovery breath between them.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Hum for two beats, rest for two, then open a second hum to 'oo'.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Sing two four-beat 'loo' patterns with a two-beat recovery gap.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Sing two adjacent song phrases with the planned recovery time.

WATCH FOR THIS

The vowel opens without becoming louder or more effortful.

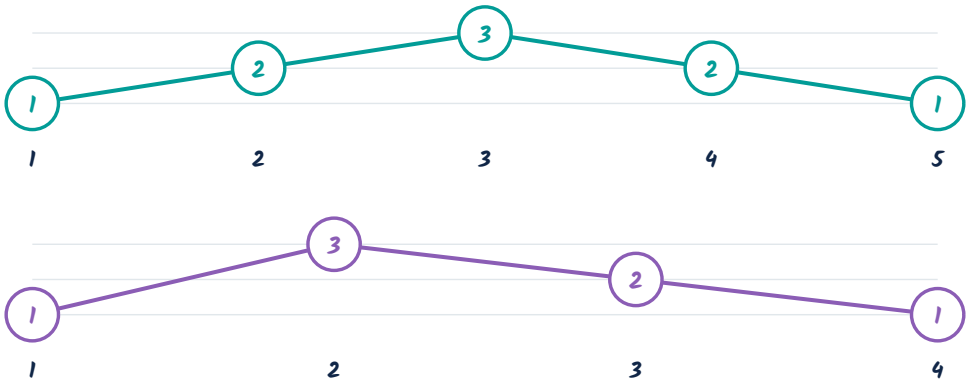
ROUTINE II

Pitch and Pulse Together

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Combine accurate note direction with a stable beat.



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Settle the group and tap a slow common pulse.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Speak four words on the pulse after a natural preparation.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Echo 1-2-3-2-1, one note per beat.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Alternate that pattern with 1-3-2-1; listen fully before responding.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Find the matching pattern in the score and sing it without losing the beat.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

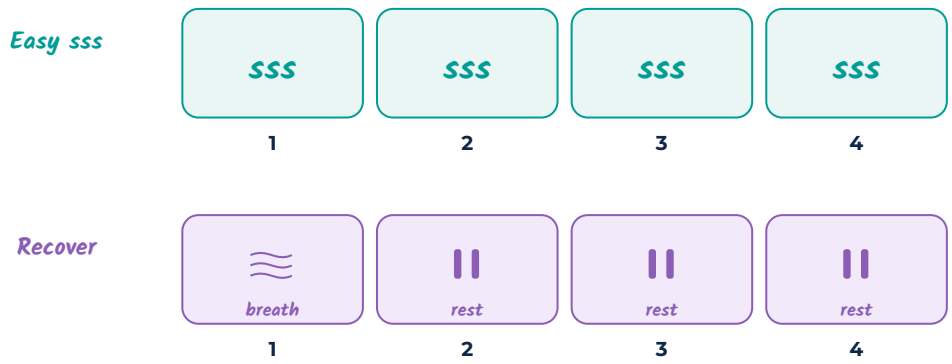
ROUTINE 12

Gentle Dynamic Control

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare two useful volume levels without forcing.



One even four-beat release, then normal breathing before another attempt.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Release a rigid posture and choose a comfortable upper volume.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Take an ordinary breath and speak a short line gently, then at normal conversational level.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing a comfortable note first gently and then at medium level, resting between turns.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Use a short three-note phrase with a small growth that stops at the agreed ceiling.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Apply the two levels to contrasting lines in the music without changing tempo.

WATCH FOR THIS

The air stream stays even and the ending does not collapse or squeeze.

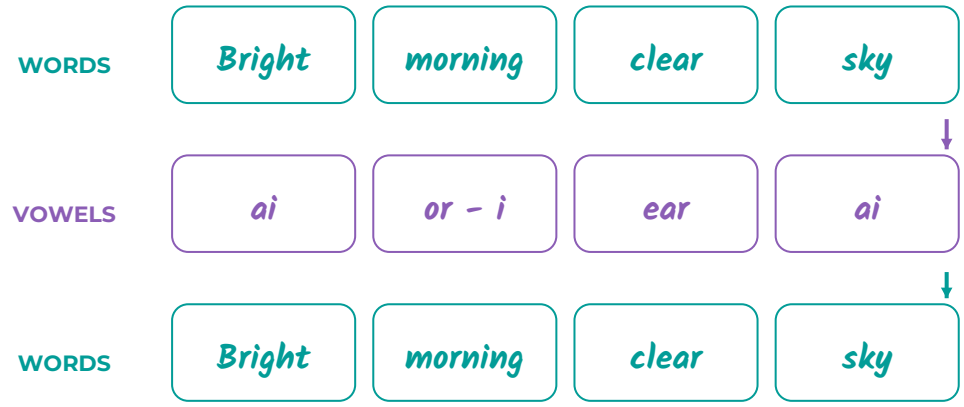
ROUTINE 13

Clean Group Endings

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Coordinate the final vowel, consonant, and release.



A simplified teaching example: restore the words without losing the vowel line.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Check sightlines and rehearse the release gesture silently.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Sing a three-beat note after an easy breath and release on beat four.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Use 'oo' for the same task, maintaining the vowel until the cue.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Sing 'light', placing its final 't' at the release rather than early.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Practise the final two words of the repertoire and reconnect the full ending.

WATCH FOR THIS

The restored text remains as connected as the vowel-only version.

ROUTINE 14

Two-Part Listening

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

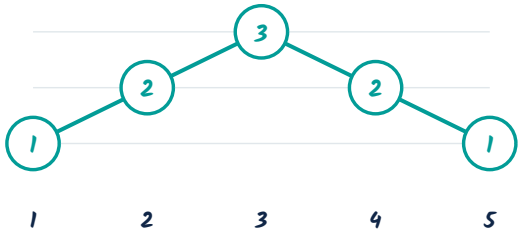
12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Introduce a second sound without overpowering it.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Place two groups where each can hear the other clearly.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Use brief phrases with ample recovery time; nobody sustains beyond comfort.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Establish a gentle home note on 'oo', then rest.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

One group sings home while the other sings 1-2-3-2-1; exchange after a rest.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Apply the listening balance to two overlapping lines in current music.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

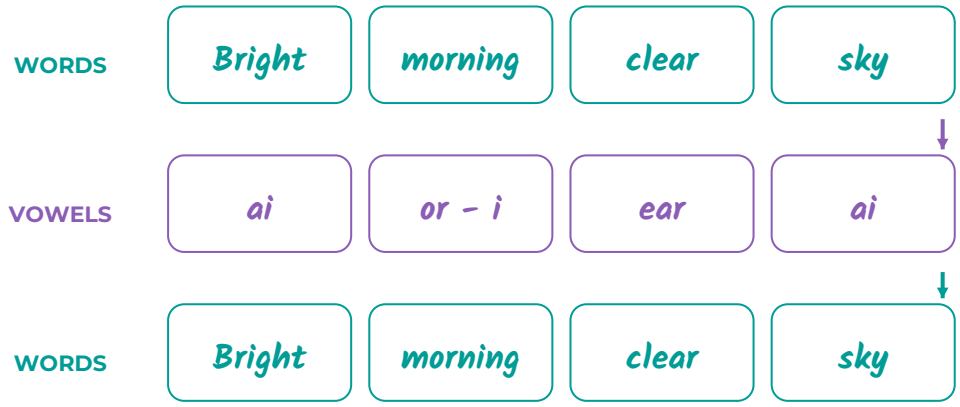
ROUTINE 15

Text With Direction

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Carry meaning through a connected phrase.



A simplified teaching example: restore the words without losing the vowel line.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Speak the lyric and choose one word as its destination.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Mark a breath that supports that meaning without splitting a word.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing a three-note 'loo' line with a gentle forward sense.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Sing the actual vowels toward the selected word, keeping surrounding syllables clear.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Restore the words and ask listeners which word carried the message.

WATCH FOR THIS

The restored text remains as connected as the vowel-only version.

ROUTINE 16

Prepared Page Turn

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Keep the first note secure after handling the score.



ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

Keep one comfortable pitch and a similar volume as the vowel opens.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Arrange folders and identify a safe page-turn location.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Practise the turn silently while breathing normally and watching for the next cue.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing one brief 'mm-oo' after a preparation gesture.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Sing a short phrase, turn the page, and listen to a fresh starting note before continuing.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Practise the real page turn between two song fragments without rushing.

WATCH FOR THIS

The vowel opens without becoming louder or more effortful.

ROUTINE 17

Recovery After Silence

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Maintain readiness through an instrumental or spoken gap.



mm — oo — oh

ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

Keep one comfortable pitch and a similar volume as the vowel opens.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Choose a visible place to watch during the gap.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Take ordinary breaths through the silence rather than preparing too early and holding air.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Hear a comfortable reference, hum it, then rest.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Sing a short pattern, think it silently for two beats, and return on cue.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Rehearse the re-entry after the longest silence in today's music.

WATCH FOR THIS

The vowel opens without becoming louder or more effortful.

ROUTINE 18

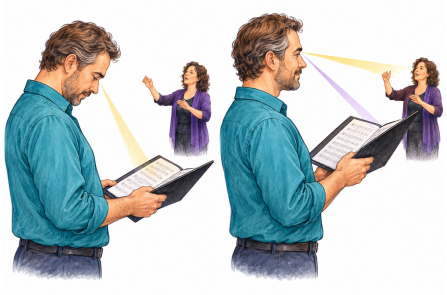
Performance Opening

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

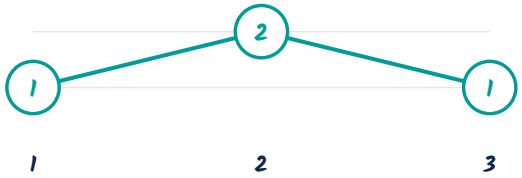
12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare a reliable opening without over-rehearsing it.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Rehearse arrival, score position, and eye contact once.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Follow the director's silent preparation with an easy breath.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing 1-2-1 gently, then rest before any transposition.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Sing the opening words on one note, aligning initial consonants and vowels.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Perform only the first ten seconds twice, with a full reset and useful feedback between attempts.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

ROUTINE 19

Phrase-Level Integration

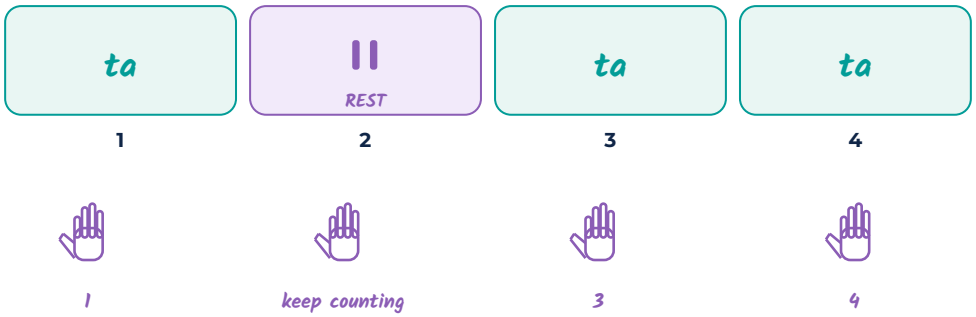
Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Transfer several established skills into one short passage.

Then rest before another attempt

FOUR EVEN BEATS



Beat 2 is an action: open the hands silently and keep counting.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Name one posture adjustment and one musical focus for today.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Speak the passage and agree the shared breath location.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing its smallest pitch pattern on 'oo', choosing a comfortable key.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Restore rhythm and vowels, then the complete text without adding extra effort.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Sing the whole passage and assess only the chosen focus, recording one next action.

WATCH FOR THIS

The note after the rest arrives on time without an extra cue.

ROUTINE 20

Independent Warm-Up Plan

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Help singers understand why a routine is chosen.



mm — oo — oh

ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

Keep one comfortable pitch and a similar volume as the vowel opens.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Ask the choir to identify today's main need: readiness, clarity, timing, or expression.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Choose an easy breath-and-speech preparation that fits that need.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Select either gentle humming or a short three-note echo, with recovery breaks.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Choose one rhythm, vowel, or listening task that directly addresses the selected need.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Apply the task to a real phrase and explain what improved and what still needs work.

WATCH FOR THIS

The vowel opens without becoming louder or more effortful.